

2024

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK



MAHARISHI
INTERNATIONAL
UNIVERSITY

HUMAN RESOURCES DEPARTMENT

Maharishi International University

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This manual replaces any previous employee manual. The policies, terms, and provisions of this manual may change without notice at the sole discretion of the University.

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FOUNDING GOALS, MISSION, AND CORE VALUES

Founding Goals

- To develop the full potential of the individual.
- To realize the highest ideal of education.
- To improve governmental achievements.
- To solve the age-old problem of crime and behaviors that bring unhappiness to our global family.
- To bring fulfillment to the economic aspirations of individuals and society.
- To maximize the intelligent use of the environment.
- To achieve the spiritual goals of humanity in this generation.

Mission: Higher Education for Higher Consciousness

At Maharishi International University, we recognize that everyone has an infinite field of creativity, intelligence, and happiness within. Our mission is to help students awaken this field in their everyday experience, enriching all aspects of their lives.

We expand the traditional scope of education to nurture the whole person: consciousness, mind, body, and relationships. We welcome students who seek to develop their full potential through a holistic education that integrates the growth of consciousness with cutting-edge knowledge and invaluable career skills.

We call this Consciousness-Based Education.

Consciousness-Based Education combines daily practice of the Transcendental Meditation (TM) technique taught by Maharishi Mahesh Yogi with an approach to learning grounded in deep, universal principles of life — principles rooted in the world's most ancient and venerable knowledge traditions, now verified by the latest scientific breakthroughs.

The TM technique enables students to optimize brain functioning and grow demonstrably in intelligence, creativity, learning ability, and overall well-being — the foundation for personal fulfillment and professional success.

We offer innovative academic programs that emphasize experiential learning and core skills that will serve students throughout their lives, no matter where their journey takes them. Our professors are dedicated to helping students achieve their goals and to continuously improving teaching and learning. Through their scholarship and creative work, faculty expand and apply profound knowledge of both consciousness and their academic disciplines.

In every course, students experience how all fields of knowledge are interconnected and emerge from consciousness, their own Self. This enables students to understand knowledge deeply, feel at home with every subject, and become genuinely excited about learning and developing the full potential of their own consciousness.

Our students thrive in an inclusive, mutually supportive community that welcomes people from all belief systems and walks of life — a community where everyone is committed to personal growth, raising the quality of collective consciousness, and addressing urgent societal needs to change the world for the better.

Core Values

Our Core Values at Maharishi International University express key principles that inform, guide, and serve as touchpoints for our educational and management practices and our campus culture.

1. Development of consciousness

We are committed to developing our full potential — intellectual, emotional, physical, and spiritual — through the application of proven technologies of consciousness, including the Transcendental Meditation technique and its advanced programs. We are further committed to serving society through *group practice* of these technologies, scientifically demonstrated to promote positive trends and reduce negative trends in society. Finally, we are committed to preserving our Founder's unique and invaluable scientific knowledge of consciousness in its completeness and purity, generation after generation.

2. Engaged learning

We value engaged learning and inquiry centered around students, where students deepen knowledge, build vital skills, challenge assumptions, stretch boundaries, and serve their community and their world. Faculty embrace innovative best practices and expect to learn as much as the students. The faculty and students connect the deepest, most important ideas in their field with universal principles of consciousness, inspiring the students to actualize their own unlimited potential. Students, faculty, and alumni lead lives of continuous learning, service, and growth.

3. Health and happiness

We value health and well-being, safety and enjoyment, positivity, and fun.

4. Inclusive and responsive community

We welcome and celebrate a rich diversity of cultures, backgrounds, identities, and values in a community that cultivates openness and togetherness, authenticity and respect, kindness, and mutual support.

5. A thriving world

We are dedicated to solving humanity's pressing environmental and social challenges, with a vision of creating a world of peace and prosperity, compassion and justice, and harmony with nature.

HUMAN RESOURCES DEPARTMENT MISSION

Human Resources (HR) acts as a unifying force by aligning the aspirations of individuals with the vision of the University. HR provides a range of services to attract, retain, and develop qualified employees, thereby enhancing the effectiveness of MIU. Key services include recruiting, compensation and benefits, payroll, training and development, and the continuous improvement of policies to support the University's strategic priorities and core values.

EMPLOYMENT POLICIES

This manual outlines the conditions of employment for everyone working at Maharishi International University (MIU). Every employee is responsible for reading and familiarizing themselves with all points contained in this manual. Additionally, employees must sign the Policy Manual Agreement form at the end of the manual, indicating that they understand and agree to follow the policies described herein.

Equal Employment Opportunity

Maharishi International University's educational programs, staff positions, and benefits are available to all people without distinction as to sex, age, race, religion, national origin, disability, or veteran's status. Institutions of higher education are required by law (Title VI and Title VII of the Civil Rights Act of 1963; Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act of 1973; and the Americans with Disabilities Act of 1990) to provide this broad access to their educational programs and to serve society in a way that treats with equal dignity the diversity of individuals and groups which comprise our society.

Hiring Policies and Procedures

Requisitions

We expect Hiring Managers to fill out a [job requisition form](#) for any openings within their departments. The Vice President of the designated department must approve requisitions and communicate approval to the HR Department before the job is posted for applications. Every job requisition must contain:

- Position Title.
- Position Shifts (if applicable).
- Number of hours an employee is expected to work.
- Reason for the Opening: Replacement/New Opening – the Executive Committee must first approve new openings.
- Job Description, including responsibilities and necessary qualifications.
- Special advertisement or recruitment instructions that are necessary for the position.

HR Meeting with Hiring Manager

HR can elect to meet with the Hiring Manager, if necessary (in person or by other means, such as Teams or Zoom), prior to posting a requisition to learn more about the position, requirements and to specify the profile of the ideal candidate.

Job Postings

HR **MUST** be the only department responsible for all and any job postings, whether internal or external. Jobs will remain posted on the [MIU Career Center website](#) until the positions are filled. The HR Department will also be the one responsible for tracking all applicants and archiving applications and resumes.

Applicants

Internal Applicants

Current employees with a satisfactory employment status can apply for job openings. The recruiter in HR and the Hiring Managers will review all applicants based on their qualifications and ability to successfully perform the job according to the job description. Internal applicants who meet the job criteria and are being considered for hire must obtain approval for their departmental transfer plan from both their manager and HR. The HR Department will notify internal applicants if they are not selected for the position.

External Applicants

All external applicants will be reviewed on their qualifications and ability to perform the job successfully, based on the job description of the position they are applying for.

Interview Process

The HR Department and the Hiring Manager will screen resumes prior to scheduling phone or in-person interviews. Hiring Managers can reach candidates directly, but **they MUST submit a candidate evaluation form to HR through the HR system (ADP) after each interview conducted.** Hiring Managers will also be expected to only use questions previously approved by the HR Department for any interviews.

The HR Department will be the one responsible for notifying candidates who are not selected.

Job Offers

Once the decision has been made to hire a candidate, an offer will be made contingent on the satisfactory completion of background checks and any additional tests necessary for the specific position.

Recommendations

Along with the offer, the candidates selected for the openings must submit one professional and one personal recommendation and, if they are already meditators, they will also be required to submit two TM Teacher recommendations.

The HR Department will check the recommendations and will be responsible for keeping all the information on the candidates' records.

Candidate Rejection due to Background Check Results

The HR Department will manage communication with any candidate who has been made an offer and no longer qualifies for employment with Maharishi International University due to background check results. **Hiring Managers will be kept apprised but should not communicate with candidates about this type of issue.**

Employee Referral Program

Description

MIU is always looking for talented employees, and we can work together on our recruiting initiatives! Research has shown, and our experience supports, that new hires who come into a workplace through employee referrals are excellent team members, stay with the company longer, and are more cost-effective recruits.

That is where you come in! If you know someone who would be a good addition to MIU's workforce, you may be awarded a referral bonus of \$300 (less taxes) if you refer candidates who are hired, after they complete their probation time.

Employees must refer candidates to Human Resources by submitting a [candidate referral form](#) and a resume.

Payment of Funds

The delivery of funds will be processed through regular direct deposit by payroll once the referee is employed for at least three months without any performance-related issues or warnings (waiting time/probation of three months).

Program Rules

- All MIU employees, except those at the vice president level and above, Human Resources personnel, and managers with hiring authority over the referred candidates, are eligible for the referral bonus.
- The referral date cannot be earlier than when the job opening is posted. A referred employee must be hired within 180 days (six months) of the initial referral date.
- The referral must represent the candidate's first contact with MIU. Temporary, summer, contract, and former employees of MIU are not eligible candidates for referral awards.
- To be eligible for an award, an employee must submit a referral to Human Resources with a candidate referral form and a resume.
- The referring employee must agree to have their name used when MIU contacts the candidate.
- The first employee to refer a candidate will be the only referring employee eligible for payment.
- Only candidates who meet the essential qualifications for the position will be considered.
- All candidates will be evaluated for employment consistent with university policies and procedures.
- All information regarding the hiring decision will remain strictly confidential.
- MIU must employ the referring employee during the hired candidate's first 90 days of employment to receive payment of the referral bonus and entry into the quarterly drawing.
- Any disputes or interpretations of this employee referral program will be managed through Human Resources.
- All referral bonus payments will be paid within one pay period after the waiting time/probation is fulfilled.

ADA/ADAAA Policy

The creation of a harmonious and unified University community is a major priority of Maharishi International University. The things that unify us are far more profound than the things that make us different. That diversity is a positive force, the diverse cultures, strengths, aptitudes, and abilities that we each have create a wholeness that is truly more than the sum of its diverse parts. The disability and discrimination laws of the United States support this vision and the respect that all the members of the community deserve. The University supports these laws not only because they are the law but because they speak to who we are as a community.

MIU complies with all federal and state laws concerning the employment of persons with disabilities and acts in accordance with regulations and guidance issued by the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission (EEOC).

The Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) and the Americans with Disabilities Amendments Act (ADAAA) are federal laws that require employers with 15 or more employees to not discriminate against applicants and individuals with disabilities and, when needed, to provide reasonable accommodations to applicants and employees who are qualified for a job, with or without reasonable accommodations, so that they may perform the essential job duties of the position.

Hiring Procedures Under this Policy

When an individual with a disability requests accommodation and can be reasonably accommodated without creating an undue hardship or causing a direct threat to workplace safety, he or she will be given the same consideration for employment as any other applicant. Applicants

who pose a direct threat to the health, safety and well-being of themselves or others in the workplace when the threat cannot be eliminated by reasonable accommodation will not be hired.

Procedures for an Employee to Request Accommodation

MIU will reasonably accommodate qualified individuals with a disability so that they can perform the core functions of a job, as prescribed in the job description for their position, unless doing so causes a direct threat to these individuals or others in the workplace and the threat cannot be eliminated by reasonable accommodation or if the accommodation creates an undue hardship to the institution.

Any requests for accommodation should be directed to HR, which will involve other departments if HR staff believes necessary. Requests for accommodation should be accompanied by a doctor's note explaining the nature of the disability the institution is being requested to accommodate.

Current employees who pose a direct threat to the health or safety of themselves or other individuals in the workplace will be placed on leave (paid or unpaid depending on availability and HR/Managerial decision) until an organizational decision has been made about the employee's immediate employment situation.

Individuals who are currently using illegal drugs are excluded from coverage under the MIU's ADA policy.

The HR Department is responsible for implementing this policy, including the resolution of reasonable accommodation, safety/direct threat, and undue hardship issues.

Service Animals and Emotional Support Animals

Regarding accommodations sought by those with an identified disability who wish animals in the workplace, those requests should be made as soon as possible after hire to minimize the delay in making such arrangements, if appropriate. Qualified Service Animals (QSA) are animals specifically trained to work or perform tasks for the benefit of an individual with an identified disability.

QSA's may be considered for allowance in the workplace if not unduly burdensome. Appropriate professional documentation of the disability and the assisting tasks should be provided for a determination as to the propriety of the QSA accommodation and its manner of implementation. The animal must be professionally trained and always supervised.

Emotional Support Animals (ESA), as distinguished from Service Animals, are not normally allowed in the workplace under the law and University policy. Requests for an ESA should be made to Human Resources to determine if, in the given circumstances, the Department involved may be willing or able to make such an accommodation. Offsite work arrangements may also be considered in these circumstances.

Terminology

As used in this ADA/ADAAA Policy, the following terms have the indicated meaning:

- **Disability:** A physical or mental impairment that substantially limits one or more major life activities of the individual, a record of such an impairment, or being regarded as having such an impairment.
- **Major life activities:** Term includes caring for oneself, performing manual tasks, seeing, hearing, eating, sleeping, walking, standing, lifting, bending, speaking, breathing, learning, reading, concentrating, thinking, communicating, and working.
- **Major bodily functions:** Term includes physical or mental impairment such as any physiological disorder or condition, cosmetic disfigurement or anatomical loss affecting

one or more body systems, such as neurological, musculoskeletal, special sense organs, respiratory (including speech organs), cardiovascular, reproductive, digestive, genitourinary, immune, circulatory, hemic, lymphatic, skin and endocrine. Also covered are any mental or psychological disorders, such as intellectual disability, organic brain syndrome, emotional or mental illness and specific learning disabilities.

- Substantially limiting: In accordance with the ADAAA final regulations, the determination of whether an impairment substantially limits a major life activity requires an individualized assessment, and an impairment that is episodic or in remission may also meet the definition of disability if it would substantially limit a major life activity when active. Some examples of these types of impairments may include epilepsy, hypertension, asthma, diabetes, major depressive disorder, bipolar disorder, and schizophrenia. An impairment, such as cancer that is in remission but that may possibly return in a substantially limiting form, is also considered a disability under EEOC final ADAAA regulations.
- Direct threat: A significant risk to the health, safety, or well-being of individuals with disabilities or others when this risk cannot be eliminated by reasonable accommodation.
- Qualified individual: An individual who, with or without reasonable accommodation, can perform the essential functions of the employment position that such individual holds or desires.
- Reasonable accommodation: Includes any changes to the work environment and may include making existing facilities readily accessible to and usable by individuals with disabilities, job restructuring, part-time or modified work schedules, telecommuting, reassignment to a vacant position, acquisition or modification of equipment or devices, appropriate adjustment or modifications of examinations, training materials or policies, the provision of qualified readers or interpreters, and other similar accommodations for individuals with disabilities.
- Undue hardship: An action requiring significant difficulty or expense by the employer. In determining whether accommodation would impose an undue hardship on a covered entity, factors to be considered include.
 - The nature and cost of the accommodation.
 - The overall financial resources of the facility or facilities involved in the provision of the reasonable accommodation, the number of persons employed at such facility, the effect on expenses and resources, or the impact of such accommodation on the operation of the facility.
 - The overall financial resources of the employer, the size, number, type, and location of facilities.
 - The type of operations of the company, including the composition, structure, and functions of the workforce; administrative or fiscal relationship of the particular facility involved in making the accommodation to the employer.
- Essential functions of the job: Term refers to those job activities that are found by the employer to be essential or core to performing the job; these functions cannot be modified.

The examples provided in the above terms are not meant to be all-inclusive and should not be construed as such. They are not the only conditions that are disabilities, impairments or reasonable accommodations covered by the ADA/ADAAA policy.

At-Will Employment

All employment and compensation with Maharishi International University is at-will in that it can be terminated with or without cause, and with or without notice, at any time, at the option of either Maharishi International University or the employee, except as otherwise provided by Iowa law.

Consulting Policy

Departments may not hire outside consultants or contractors to perform a service that is already being performed within the University or for which the University has a pre-existing contract (e.g., personal counseling with Optima Life Services) **without approval by the Executive Committee or President's Cabinet**. This includes, but is not limited to, the following services:

- Web design
- Marketing
- Personal counseling and therapy.

Contractors must be approved by the HR Department and fill out a contractor agreement prior to being authorized to perform any services to MIU.

Job Description

Applicants are hired for the areas in which they have skill or interest. However, due to the changing needs of the University, employees may be transferred temporarily or permanently to other departments at the discretion of the University. Therefore, employees need to be willing to do other duties as assigned. As a result, job descriptions may vary and, in all cases, are determined by HR and the area department head or supervisor.

Introductory Period

The first two months of employment at MIU are considered an introductory period for all employees. This period allows employees to become acquainted with their colleagues, department head, job responsibilities, and the University itself. During this time, the University will evaluate the employee's suitability for the position, and the new employee can assess the University as well. If an employee's work habits, attitude, attendance, and performance are not satisfactory during this period, they may be asked to leave.

Department heads and the Human Resources Office will collaborate closely with employees to help them understand their job requirements and processes.

The introductory period is included in the employee's first year of service for the purpose of calculating accrued paid vacation time.

Anniversary Date

The anniversary date is the date that employees begin working for pay at MIU and is used to compute various conditions and benefits based on consecutive service.

Nepotism Policy

The University seeks to foster a working environment in which people are treated with respect and fairness and without any potential for conflict of interest or an appearance of favoritism. To promote these goals, the University's Nepotism policies are as follows:

A. No person shall be offered or denied compensated employment or any favored term or condition of employment on a preferential basis merely because that person is a relative (i.e. spouse, child, parent, grandparent, brother, sister, niece, nephew, aunt, uncle, grandchild, and in-law or step-relative of same) of another person currently employed at the University.

B. No employee shall initiate or participate in any personnel decisions pertaining to a relative, such decisions may involve issues of hiring, retention, termination, discipline, leave, performance review, salary, benefits, promotion, or transfer, whether or not in the same department or reporting line as the relative. The unrelated direct supervisor of the relative shall determine, along with a designated HR or Dean of Faculty (DOF) representative what, if any, alternative procedures shall be employed in making such personnel decisions fair and impartial.

Employment Eligibility

MIU participates in E-Verify and will provide the federal government with employees' form I-9 information to confirm that they are authorized to work in the U.S. If E-Verify cannot confirm that they are authorized to work, MIU is required to give them written instructions and an opportunity to contact the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) or Social Security Administration (SSA) so that employees can begin to resolve the issue before MIU can take any action against them, including terminating their employment. We can only use E-Verify once employees have accepted a job offer and completed the Form I-9 (employment eligibility form).

Jury Duty Policy

Objective

To provide income protection while an employee fulfills his or her civic responsibility, MIU provides the difference between jury duty pay and an employee's regular day's pay for time spent serving on jury duty. Income protection for time spent serving on jury duty will be provided for a maximum of five workdays. Additional income-protected time away from the workplace for this purpose will be considered on a case-by-case basis and must be approved by HR.

Eligibility

Full-time employees are eligible to receive this benefit.

Procedures to Request

Upon receipt of notification from the state or federal courts of an obligation to serve on a jury or to function as a court witness, the employee should notify their supervisor. The employee is required to provide copies of the subpoena or jury summons to their immediate manager and to the Human Resources Department.

The manager must verify the notification by contacting the office issuing the summons or subpoena and make scheduling adjustments to accommodate the employee's obligation. The manager will also supply court documentation to Human Resources for processing. Employees appearing in their own case as a plaintiff or defendant or for a non-subpoena court appearance will not receive paid time off. Vacation or unpaid time should be used for such instances.

Work Schedule

Work Hours

In all cases, the employee's specific schedule should be determined by the department head and/or supervisor.

Part-Time: The part-time schedule is 29 hours per week or less.

Full-Time: The full-time schedule is between 30 and 40 hours per week. Anything less than 30 hours per week is considered part-time and will result in a loss of full-time benefits. Salaried employees are expected to work a minimum of 35 hours per week. Anything more than 40 hours per week for hourly employees will require overtime to be pre-approved by the employee's supervisor and HR. Requests for overtime should be made only in exceptional cases where there is a clear, approved, and budgeted business need.

Graduate assistantship program participants (formerly called interns) work a maximum of 20 hours per week when classes are in session. When classes are not in session (summer break) they should work a minimum of 35 hours per week, and a maximum of 40 hours per week.

Flex Time: Each department can fine-tune their daily schedules to meet the full-time requirement, however we need to keep **open office hours** in mind, which are usually 9:30 AM to 4:30 PM, to maintain some consistency across all departments.

The University reserves the right to determine and change, if necessary, the schedule of work hours.

Time Sheet

All hourly employees are required to use the Time and Attendance tool in ADP to track hours worked. It is the responsibility of the employee to approve their time at the end of the pay period to ensure accuracy.

Missed punches or wrong punches will need to be fixed by supervisors, or someone designated by them. Supervisors are the ones responsible for timesheet approval, this responsibility cannot be delegated. Failure to follow these procedures may be grounds for disciplinary measures.

Lunch

All employees working a full-time schedule are expected to take a mandatory minimum unpaid break of at least 30 minutes per five consecutive hours of work. The lunch break is not a paid break and should not be included in the number of hours worked. **HOURLY EMPLOYEES MUST CLOCK OUT FOR LUNCH, AND CLOCK BACK IN ONCE THEY ARE BACK TO WORK.**

Breaks

Breaks are not paid at MIU and do not count towards weekly hours. Employees must clock out when they leave on a break and clock back in once they are back to work. MIU guidelines require employees to take a break at least once a day.

Attendance Policy

All employees are expected to give the University a full day's work. Tardiness in reporting for work or unexcused part-day or full-day absences from work decreases the productivity of all other employees who may depend upon the presence of the tardy or absent employee to get the job done.

Tardiness is defined as arriving for work after the employee's designated starting time. Leaving early or unexpectedly without permission is also to be considered as tardiness.

Tardiness can be a cause for disciplinary measures that can lead to termination of employment.

Regular, punctual attendance will be a significant factor in the consideration of employee promotions and pay increases.

Special Project Assignments

One of the dynamic aspects of being on staff and faculty at MIU is the unique opportunity to come together for special projects, including graduation, events, and phone calling for fundraising campaigns, as needed throughout the year, often at times other than at ordinary work hours. The Human Resources Department coordinates these projects, so employees may expect to be asked to attend these events.

Safety and Security

Campus Safety (ext. 1115 or 641-472-1115) oversees all aspects of safety on campus, including medical emergencies, fires, or fire alarms. For medical emergencies, fires or fire alarms, accidents, severe intoxication or overdose, and violence (use of force or threat of force directed towards yourself or others): call 911 and then Campus Security. Guidelines may be found at <https://services.miu.edu/campus-security/>.

For anyone living in campus housing rooms, cooking and toaster ovens are not permitted in campus rooms not equipped with a kitchen approved by the Fire Marshall. For Fire Safety procedures [click here](#).

Employees are expected to observe and follow the security protocols and policies of MIU and prevent the loss of equipment and supplies. Storerooms and closets must be kept locked when the employee using the room is not in the immediate vicinity.

An employee who is authorized to enter a room that is locked in any building on campus must lock the room upon leaving.

Employees will be responsible to see that no supplies are left outside or in unlocked vehicles at the end of the day.

University Vehicles

All employees must have a valid, current Iowa driver's license, and receive driver safety training from the University's Campus Safety department before they can drive a university vehicle.

All employees will be expected to take good care of university vehicles and equipment, and immediately report any damage or malfunction to their department head. They are also expected to see that the equipment they use is serviced according to the regular schedule determined by the instructions in the owner's manual and/or the University Motor pool.

Vehicles are to be kept clean after each use.

University vehicles are not to be driven off campus except on work-related business with department head approval.

Vehicle keys will be checked out to the driver of the vehicle. Lost keys will be replaced immediately at the driver's expense. The driver will also be fined \$5 for each lost key.

Visitors

Children, friends, and family members are not allowed to accompany employees at work, unless the department head has granted employees prior approval to each singular visit.

Emergency Notification System

Maharishi International University has a campus-wide Emergency Notification System through Rave Wireless. This system will be used to alert employees in cases of fire, severe weather or other circumstances that require immediate action.

In the event of a campus emergency an official alert will be sent to let those in harm's way know exactly what to do, what to expect, or what to look for. An emergency alert will come to employees via e-mail, a text message, or both.

We will not be using this new system for administrative notices. Please read alerts immediately and follow the notice's instructions. We will infrequently send out a test message and these will clearly be marked as a "TEST MESSAGE." We are recommended to do this testing 2-4 times a year.

Employees can sign up for this service without our help. Please go to: [Get Rave](#). In the bottom left corner, there is a section that says, "Not registered yet?" followed by a "Register Now" button. We hope that the need never arises for this Emergency Notification System, but we want to be ready to act at short notice should the need arise.

COMPENSATION AND PERFORMANCE

Wage and Salary Policies

Method of Payment

Employees are paid via direct deposit into the checking or savings account of the bank of their choice. During the onboarding process, employees are required to provide direct deposit information through the HR System designating the bank and account number into which their pay will be deposited.

All hourly wage employees are currently paid following the Bi-Weekly (BW) Payroll Schedule, and all salaried employees are currently paid by the calendar month on the 15th of the month following the pay period. All payment including the first paycheck is paid to the employee through direct deposit. Employees are responsible for keeping updated personal information and pay information such as tax filing status in the HR System. It is the employee's responsibility to check with the bank to be sure automatic deposits are correct.

Employees will have access to their Paycheck History and paystubs in the HR System.

Overtime

The University does not allow employees to work overtime, unless previously authorized by the department head or the Human Resources Department.

Performance and Compensation Reviews

Performance Reviews

Department heads are continuously evaluating employees' job performance. Day-to-day interaction between employees and their department head should give them a clear sense of how their department head perceives their performance. Human Resources advises managers to meet with their team members at least once a month for feedback sessions so they can go over their planned goals and improvements needed in their team members' performance.

Supervisors are required to complete a 60 Day Review for each employee they oversee at the end of their employee's introductory period. You can find more details about the introductory period on page 8 of this document.

MIU also requires department heads to hold yearly performance conversations with the employees they oversee. During this process, department heads will consider the following performance topics for review, among others:

- Core Company Goals/Competencies: Enrollment Increase, Strategic Perspective, Leadership Development, Ethics, Integrity & Inclusivity, Communication, Planning & Problem Solving, Continuous Improvement, and Teamwork/Management.
- Attendance.
- Knowledge of the work and responsibilities to be performed.
- The quality and quantity of work performed.
- The conditions under which employees work.

The primary reason for performance conversations is to support employees' professional development, reinforcing their good behaviors and developing ways to improve their weaknesses. This review also serves to make employees aware of and to document how their job performance compares to the goals and description of their job.

Compensation Reviews

Wage or salary increases are based on merit, the economic climate, the departmental budget, and the established salary levels for each position. Increases are not solely based on length of service or cost of living. A compensation review does not guarantee a pay increase. Compensation reviews may be conducted alongside performance reviews but are not limited to them. Any wage increases will be reflected in the pay period following the one in which they were granted.

To request a compensation review or pay increase, the request must be approved by the department head, the executive responsible for the department, and the President.

Resignation and Termination

Resignation

All employees shall provide the Human Resources Office with at least two (2) weeks' written notice prior to the effective date of resignation. Employees who are resigning should fill out a "Departure Form" available from the Human Resources Office, obtain the necessary signatures, and submit the form to the Human Resources Office. They may also be invited to an exit interview by HR.

Termination

In the case of severe disciplinary action, the employee may be terminated immediately. In the event of a layoff, the University shall:

- 1) Provide all employees with as much notice as possible.
- 2) Conduct exit interviews with departing employees. These will become part of the employee's permanent file.

EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

Holidays

Paid holidays

The following holidays are recognized by Maharishi International University as paid holidays for **full-time employees**:

New Year's Day	Labor Day
Memorial Day	Thanksgiving Day
Independence Day (4th of July)	Christmas

If any of the above holidays occur on a Saturday, the paid holiday will be on the Friday before the holiday. If any of the above holidays occur on a Sunday, the paid holiday will be on the Monday after the holiday.

For hourly employees, the amount of pay to be received for a paid holiday will be determined by their PTO plan.

Hourly employees who are required by their managers to work on a holiday should be paid time and a half for the holiday worked. Salaried employees who are required by their managers to work on a holiday can take another day off as a comp day.

Employees who have applied for and received approval for leave without pay, or who have been laid off, shall not be eligible for paid holidays, which may occur during the leave period.

If a holiday occurs on any other day than Saturday or Sunday, the paid holiday must be taken on the day it occurs, unless an exception is made at the discretion of the department head.

Please note: Part-time employees do not receive paid holidays.

Ideal Administrators – Room and Board

Ideal Administrators are required to live on campus and participate in our Super Radiance Program. This is a condition of their employment with MIU. Their Room and Board (housing and meals) are part of their compensation package. The values attributed to these non-cash benefits are as stated below:

- 1-bedroom Dorm + utilities: \$300/month
- 2-bedroom apartment + utilities: \$600/month
- 3-bedroom apartment + utilities: \$900/month
- 4-bedroom apartment + utilities: \$1,200/month
- 5-bedroom apartment + utilities: \$1,500/month
- Vastu Apartment + utilities: \$1,500/month
- Vastu House + utilities: \$2,500/month
- Trailer + utilities: \$600/month
- Meal Plan: \$900/month for the All Meals Plan

These benefits cannot be exchanged for cash and in case the conditions established by the Ideal Administrator Program are not met, employees might be liable to taxes on the dollar value of these benefits. The advisory board has approved a modest charge for utilities to all employees living on housing provided by the University. Employees will be asked to sign a deduction form for this payment.

Ideal Administrators may have immediate family members stay on campus for two weeks per year with a room provided at no extra charge. Before inviting family members, please contact the Human Resources Department for approval of your request. Once approval is obtained, contact the Housing Office or the Guest and Conference Center to determine the availability of suitable housing. Other guests of Ideal Administrators must pay the regular rates. Ideal Administrators who host non-dependent family members, such as boarding students, must pay a fee of \$100 dollars per month to cover additional utilities and wear and tear of on campus housing.

Celebrations and Staff Meetings

Ideal Administrators, graduate assistantships participants and salaried staff members are paid when they attend celebrations and staff meetings occurring during normal business hours which are sponsored by the University and to which they have been invited. Full-time hourly employees are paid when they attend the staff holiday party and required staff meetings. Part-time employees are invited, but not paid to attend celebrations and staff meetings.

Family and Medical Leave (FMLA)

The Family and Medical Leave Act (FMLA) entitles an “eligible employee”—an employee who has worked for Maharishi International University for at least one year, and for 1,250 hours over the previous 12 months—to take up to a total of 12 work weeks of unpaid leave during any 12-month period for the birth of a child and to care for such child, for the placement of a child, for adoption or foster care, to care for a spouse, parent, or child with a serious health condition, or when he or she is unable to work because of a serious health condition. You will be required to provide medical certification to support your request. The University asks that you provide 30 days

advance notification when the leave is “foreseeable.” This is a summary of our full FMLA policy, you can contact the Human Resources Department for the full policy, or access it directly on the [MIU HR Website](#).

Use of Paid and Unpaid Leave

An employee who is taking FMLA leave because of the employee’s own serious health condition, or the serious health condition of a family member must use all paid vacation, personal or sick leave prior to being eligible for unpaid leave. Sick leave may be run concurrently with FMLA leave if the reason for the FMLA leave is covered by the established sick leave policy.

Disability leaves for the birth of a child and for an employee’s serious health condition, including workers’ compensation leave (to the extent that it qualifies), will be designated as FMLA leave and will run concurrently with FMLA. For example, if MIU provides six weeks of pregnancy disability leave, the six weeks will be designated as FMLA leave and counted toward the employee’s 12-week entitlement. The employee may then be required to substitute accrued (or earned) paid leave as appropriate before being eligible for unpaid leave for what remains of the 12-week entitlement. An employee who is taking leave for the adoption or foster care of a child must use all paid vacation, personal or family leave prior to being eligible for unpaid leave.

An employee who is using military FMLA leave for a qualifying exigency must use all paid vacation and personal leave prior to being eligible for unpaid leave. An employee using FMLA military caregiver leave must also use all paid vacation, personal leave, or sick leave (if the reason for the absence is covered by the University’s sick leave policy) prior to being eligible for unpaid leave.

Procedure to Request FMLA

All employees requesting FMLA leave must provide verbal or written notice of the need for the leave to the HR Department. Within five business days after the employee has provided this notice, HR will complete and provide the employee with the DOL Notice of Eligibility and Rights.

When the need for the leave is foreseeable, the employee must provide the employer with at least 30 days’ notice. When an employee becomes aware of a need for FMLA leave less than 30 days in advance, the employee must provide notice of the need for the leave either the same day the need for leave is discovered or the next business day. When the need for FMLA leave is not foreseeable, the employee must comply with the University’s usual and customary notice and procedural requirements for requesting leave, absent unusual circumstances.

Designation of FMLA Leave

Within five business days after the employee has submitted the appropriate certification form, the HR Department will complete and provide the employee with a written response to the employee’s request for FMLA leave using the DOL Designation Notice.

Parental Leave

MIU offers 12 weeks of paid parental leave in the event of the birth or adoption of a child for full-time employees who have worked a minimum of three consecutive years full-time prior to the leave start date. In case both parents work for MIU, the Parental Leave is per event not per person and, therefore, parents have 12 weeks to split between them at their discretion. This leave will be designated as FMLA leave and will be counted towards the 12-week FMLA entitlement.

Employees who do not qualify under this policy will be covered by regular unpaid FMLA leave, as per current FMLA policy.

Sick Days

Full-time salaried and hourly, Ideal Administrators, as well as intern employees earn sick days. Sick days are non-cumulative and are accrued monthly as per the PTO plan assigned to the employee. Part-time hourly employees do not receive paid sick leave.

If an employee becomes ill after leaving work and is not able to report for work the next day, the employee must be responsible for calling the University and informing his/her department head by 10:15 AM of an inability to report for work that morning, the reason why, and the expected day of return to work. Failure to provide the University with notice as required shall be considered an unexcused absence.

If an employee becomes ill during working hours and wishes to leave work, they must report to the department head or the supervisor and inform them that they need to leave work. If an employee's department head or supervisor is unavailable, the employee should report to the University Human Resources Office. If an employee fails to report to their department head, supervisor, or the Human Resources Office before leaving work, the employee's absence will be considered an unexcused absence.

If an employee is deemed by the department head too ill to work, he or she may be excused from work.

An employee who has been absent from work due to illness shall report to their department head on the day of return to work. Sick days should be properly reported through the HR System, otherwise they will not be accounted by the payroll office and, therefore, will not be paid.

Employees who need to miss work for more than two consecutive days should provide a note from a medical doctor to the Human Resources Office. This note should indicate that the doctor recommended time off work and how much additional absence from work, if any, is recommended.

The Human Resources Office and the department head reserve the right to request confirmation from a physician of any illness. The cost of seeing a doctor to verify illness is the responsibility of the employee.

Family Bereavement Leave

MIU offers family bereavement leave for all full-time employees after four months of employment.

Full-time employees may take up to a maximum of 30 hours of paid leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member. An immediate family member is defined as a parent, sibling, child by blood or adoption, marriage, spouse, grandparent, or grandchild.

This LOA is over and above the standard paid LOA allotment. If further time off is required, the employee may use any remaining vacation days if available, or they may apply to use unpaid LOA days if needed. If more time off is still required, then the employee may request their manager to petition the Personnel Committee to take additional days of unpaid leave.

Workers' Compensation

Employees are eligible for Workers' Compensation for any job-related injury. Anyone injured in a job-related accident must file an accident report for Workers' Compensation **within 24 hours** whenever possible.

To file, an employee must:

1. **Report the injury to the department head immediately. This point is particularly important because the department head must determine what steps to take in case of an emergency.** In addition, the department head must verify that the accident happened on the job and/or is job-related.

2. Obtain a **REPORT OF INJURY FORM** from the department head or the Human Resources Department.
3. Complete the form **within 24 hours if possible** and immediately deliver it to the department head or the Human Resources Department.
4. The injured employee should see a doctor at one of two local medical clinics listed below to be covered by Workers' Compensation:

- Jefferson County Health Clinics (JCHC Clinics)
2000 South Main Street
Fairfield, IA 52556

If the clinics' doctors are unavailable, then the injured employee should be seen at:

- Jefferson County Hospital Emergency Room
2000 South Main
Fairfield, Iowa 52556

It is the employee's responsibility to fill out the Report of Injury form. The department head will assist employees if they are unable to fill out the form themselves.

Tuition Credit – POLICY UNDER REVIEW, CHANGES ARE EXPECTED

Full-time employees are eligible to apply through the Human Resources Department for tuition credit to pursue study in a Maharishi International University degree-seeking program. Note that the use of tuition credit by former employees as well as by dependents (children and spouses) of current employees requires some financial contribution (cash or student loan). There is no financial contribution required for courses taken by currently employed full-time employees.

Former full-time employees who worked less than one year may earn \$600 tuition credit for each month worked for MIU.

Former full-time employees who worked more than one year may earn tuition credit for every year worked. The financial contribution required for former employees is explained below:

- Undergraduate U.S. citizens or permanent residents must contribute the maximum allowable amount of federal and state grants. If the family is not eligible for all or a portion of available government grants, this contribution must be paid toward tuition in cash or student loans.
- \$2,000 per year in cash or student loans must be paid towards tuition (\$672/year if Distance Education or Evening-weekend programs). This payment is waived if former employee worked more than 5 years and is an undergraduate U.S. student.
- Former employees must pay for housing and meals when using dorm housing. Former employees who are U.S. citizens and permanent residents will receive housing and meals at no cost.

Children and dependent spouses of current full-time employees may be eligible for tuition credit. Acquisition of tuition credit ends when the full-time employee leaves their position. Spouses who are not legal dependents are not eligible.

- Housing/Meals/Fees are not charged if the employee is living on campus.
- Government Grant contribution is also required by dependents who are undergraduates and USA Citizens or permanent residents. This contribution is the maximum allowable federal and state grants or the equivalent amount in cash or loans if the family does not qualify for the maximum grant allowable due to family income.

- \$2,000 per year in cash or student loans must be paid towards tuition (\$672/year if Distance Education or Evening-weekend programs).
- Security Deposit is paid by children but not by spouses.

Important Notes:

- The granting of tuition credit is awarded by the Human Resources Department based on work performance and conduct. **Employees who have been dismissed for cause or because of a disciplinary procedure will not be granted tuition credit as former employees.**
- Former full-time employees who qualify for tuition credit must begin their academic program within one year of leaving the University; otherwise, credit and eligibility for tuition credit is forfeited.
- Tuition credit may be used to pursue any degree level (undergraduate, Masters, or PhD), and may be used for more than one degree, but not for more than one degree per level (for example, not for two master's degrees). Once tuition credit begins to be used, there can be no break (a full semester without enrollment) in the pursuit of the academic program, except in the case of an exception made by the Human Resources Department, such as a family emergency.
- The use of tuition credit is not automatic or guaranteed. Qualifications for admission to the academic program are evaluated by the Admissions Office.
- Tuition credit may not be used for Rotating University travel expenses, the TM Teacher Training program, student fees, lab fees, or security deposits.

Meditation Programs and Advanced Courses

Transcendental Meditation

Staff TM Benefit

Training in learning the Transcendental Meditation technique is paid for by the University and provided during work hours as part of employees' onboarding training. This takes place during seven one-hour sessions in the first month of employment. HR and the department head will coordinate the schedule for this training and communicate it to new employees.

Employees will not be monitored on their Transcendental Meditation practice or required to meditate during work hours.

Dependents TM Benefit

MIU offers TM instruction as a benefit to the dependent children of staff and faculty members. A dependent child is defined under this policy as being of age up to and including high school 12th grade. There are two important points to be observed under the policy governing TM instruction for dependent children:

- If the dependent child is learning TM in Fairfield, then MIU will arrange the instruction and will cover all the TM instruction expenses.
- If the dependent child is learning TM at a center outside of Fairfield, then there will be a fee of \$210 paid at the time of instruction by the employee/dependent child.

Advanced Techniques

After their first year of employment, MIU employees are eligible for special pricing on the TM Advanced Techniques according to the table below.

Full-Time Staff Members	One free technique per year
Part-Time Staff Members (15-29 hours/week)	One technique at \$380 per year
Part-Time Staff Members (10-14 hours/week)	One technique at \$480 per year

Residence Courses – “WPA/Rounding” LOA

After their initial two months of employment, full-time employees practicing the Transcendental Meditation technique may apply to go on a residence course using their WPA/Rounding LOA hours. Each full-time employee is entitled to 40 paid hours, non-cumulative, WPA/Rounding LOA per year. Interns are entitled to 20 paid hours, non-cumulative, WPA/Rounding per year.

Many courses coincide with the monthly long-weekend courses for students. Approval is needed from the department head, and course arrangements are made through the Development of Consciousness Office.

As with any time off requests, employees are expected to request WPA/Rounding time off through the HR System.

Center Invincibility Course (CIC)

After working at MIU for six months, full-time employees, who practice Transcendental Meditation, making a one-year commitment to continue working at MIU and attending the Dome, may apply to the David Lynch Foundation and the Peace Palace for a scholarship to the CIC. Employees who do not fulfill their one-year commitment might be required to pay back the scholarship granted.

TM Checking

Personal checking of the Transcendental Meditation technique is a simple, effortless way to verify and assure its correct practice. It is recommended that employees have their meditation checked once a month for the first year and then periodically thereafter. Checking of the Transcendental Meditation technique is available at the Maharishi Peace Palace. Please call 472-1174 to schedule a checking appointment.

Evening Knowledge Programs and Meetings

MIU offers a variety of evening knowledge programs. All staff members are encouraged to attend.

Meditators: Knowledge programs are celebrations in the Dome, courses offered through Continuing Education and Sunday evening advanced lectures at the Maharishi Peace Palace at 7:30 PM.

Those practicing the TM Siddhis Program: An evening knowledge assembly is available, which is held every evening in the Patanjali Golden Dome from 8:30–9:15 PM.

Volunteering

All the meditation and advanced programs are considered as volunteer activities for MIU staff. The University has a flexible work-schedule to provide release time for staff to participate in these programs that have been scientifically validated to improve all aspects of individual life and simultaneously create a positive influence of harmony and coherence in the environment. Staff members are also encouraged to engage in volunteer activities that support the University’s mission of creating harmony and good will within the community.

Badges

ID Badge

All employees are issued a University I.D. card with a photo (available at the Student Life Department, Dreier Building). This card serves as both an identification card and a meal pass, so please protect it against loss and misuse. It is advisable to carry this card with you at all times while on the University premises.

Transcendental Meditation or TM-Siddhis Program Badge

Those practicing the TM Siddhis Program receive an Invincible America Super Radiance badge, (at the Invincible America Department, Gate Ridge Building), which allows them to check in and participate morning and evening in the collective practice of the TM-Siddhis program in the Golden Domes. Participation in the “Invincible America” program is assessed by attendance using an electronic barcode reader, and this data is reviewed regularly. Ideal Administrators are expected to maintain regular attendance.

Meditators receive a sticker on their University I.D. badge, (at the Department of the Development of Consciousness, Room 118 in the Dreier Building), which allows them to participate twice daily in the group meditation program.

Optional Life, Legal, Medical, Dental and Vision Insurance

Full-time employees are eligible for optional life, legal, medical, dental, and vision insurance. Employees can enroll during our yearly open enrollment event, and they can contact HR through the [ticketing system](#) should they need more information regarding these optional benefits.

Meal Plans

Wholesome meals are served in the University's Argiro Student Center dining hall. Our goal is to use fresh, organic, non-GMO ingredients in all our food preparation. Employees and their eligible dependents are required to have an MIU employee and dependent ID badge that will be mandatory to scan each time they visit the dining hall. There will be a door checker to help scan badges before entering the food service area.

Eligibility and Assignment of Meal Plans

Full-Time Employees: Salaried and hourly employees who work 30 hours or more per week.

- **Employees Living On Campus (Ideal Administrators, Mentoring Faculty and SRC):** Employees and their eligible dependents living on campus are eligible for all meals (3 meals per day) each month.
- **Employees Living Off Campus:** Employees and their eligible dependents living off campus will be assigned a total of 30 meals per month, which can be shared with their dependents.

Part-Time Employees: Hourly employees working a minimum of 15 hours per week are eligible for 10 meals per month.

Eligible Dependents: Must live with the employee and be up to age 26.

Meal Plan Renewal and Updates

On the first day of each month, the employee meal plan will be renewed. Any previously unused meals will not roll over nor will there be a monetary value redeemed.

Misuse and Disciplinary Actions: Dining Hall staff will report any misuse of an employee's or dependent's meal badge. Misuse of this benefit can result in disciplinary procedures, and a written warning will be issued. According to current disciplinary procedures, three warnings can be

grounds for termination. Employees should understand that the meal plan issued to employees is a benefit and is not transferable or refundable for cash.

Address and Employment Status Changes

Employees are required to update their address in ADP immediately if it changes. This could change the meal plan based on whether they live on or off campus.

Changes in employment status from full-time to part-time or vice versa will also change the employee's meal plan, including their dependents.

If the employee uses up their monthly meals, they can purchase more through OneCard.

Profile and Dependent Information: It is important that employees keep their profiles and dependents' information updated in ADP. This helps ensure that employees receive the meal plan available to them.

University Sports Facilities and Swimming Pool

The Recreation Center, including indoor tennis courts, basketball courts, track, gymnastics area, weight room, and climbing wall, is available to all full-time employees, their spouses, and dependents free of charge. Employees may also sign out University recreation equipment such as cross-country skis, ice skates, canoes, kayaks, and windsurfing equipment and bicycles. (Instruction in the safe use of some equipment may be required.) Full-time employees may use the University outdoor swimming pool for a nominal charge. Please present your staff I.D. badge to use the facilities or equipment.

The Recreation Center is generally open Monday–Friday from 7 AM to 9 PM and Saturday and Sunday from 10 AM to 7 PM during the academic year. Hours change during student breaks, holidays, and summer conferences, and will be posted.

Maharishi Vedic Approach to HealthSM

Staff and Faculty Preventive Health Center – Panchakarma (PK) LOA

MIU full-time employees can take up to 30 hours of paid time off (non-cumulative) per year to have PK treatments in the Preventive Health Center in the Peace Palaces.

The Health Center offers the following treatment programs involving three treatments each day (offerings can change without notice to MIU, as the Clinic is an independent institution):

- Treatment 1: two technicians, 55-minute Abhyanga
- Treatment 2: 20-minute Shirodhara or Swedana
- Treatment 3: Matra or Shodana Basti (usually alternated each day)

In addition to the fee for the treatments above, the following consultation service will be provided to MIU full-time staff in either option 1 or option 2 for an additional fee. All three parts of this service will be provided by a Vaidya, overseen by a medical professional, when the Vaidya is in-residence at MIU. The three-part treatment consultation service would include:

- Recommendations for home cleansing program based on health history information you submit by internet or phone.
- Maharishi Panchakarma treatment recommendation based on an in-person, 15 minute with Vaidya Manohar before the treatment begins.

- Home program for herbs based on an in-person, 15-minute visit with Vaidya Manohar at the end of the treatment program.

Full-time employees can find more information and sign up for treatments using this link: [MIU Full-Time Staff and Faculty: PK Treatment Application](#).

Discounts on Maharishi Ayurveda Products

Full-time employees may receive a discount on Maharishi Ayurveda products, which may be purchased at the MAPI store in town with your discount sticker on your ID badge.

Leave of Absence/Paid Time Off (LOA)

The terms, conditions, and duration of all leaves of absence are subject to the approval of the department head. In this manual, leave of absence (LOA) and vacation are used interchangeably.

Procedure to Apply for LOA

Vacation benefits are available after successful completion of an employee's 60 Day Probationary Period and can be taken according to the number of hours already accrued in their vacation account. Accruals begin on day 1 of employment.

Employees should sign in into their Self-Service area in the HR System and request the LOA through the system. Managers will be notified and must approve/deny the request.

Earned paid vacations must be scheduled at least two weeks in advance and are subject to the approval of the department head. The department head will also determine the number of employees from any work group who can be on vacation at the same time.

Please note that each PTO (Paid Time Off) plan has a maximum limit for vacation accruals, which is usually twice the yearly accruals allowed in each plan. This means that once this limit is reached no more vacation hours will be earned until the balance is used.

If an employee is dismissed for misconduct or resigns without good cause (as defined under the Iowa employment law) from university service, they shall not be entitled to receive any vacation days. Additionally, furloughed employees (temporary layoffs) will not be paid accrued vacation, their accrued balance will be available for their use at the time of their rehire.

Vacation Eligibility

Ideal Administrators

Ideal Administrators (which includes Ideal Administrators paid in an hourly basis) receive 90 hours of paid vacation per year worked, which are accrued monthly, 7.5 hours per month worked.

After working continuously for ten years or more, Ideal Administrators receive 120 hours of paid vacation per year worked, accrued monthly, 10 hours per month worked. Please note that ten-year status must be verified with the Human Resources Department.

Full-Time Salaried Employees

Full-time salaried employees receive 90 hours of paid vacation per year worked, which are accrued monthly, 7.5 hours per month worked.

(Those making a four-month commitment or less do not receive LOA benefits.)

Full-Time Hourly Employees

Full-time hourly employees accrue vacation hours as per the PTO plan assigned to them.

LOA Compensation Table for Full-Time Hourly Employees

PTO Plan	Paid vacation benefit is:
Employees who work 36-40 hours per week	120 hours per year worked, 10 hours accrued monthly
Employees who work 30-35 hours per week	97.5 hours per year worked, 8.125 hours accrued monthly

Graduate Assistantship Participants (GAP) (Formerly called Interns)

GAP receive 40 hours of paid vacation per year worked, which are accrued monthly.

Part-Time Hourly Employees

Part-time hourly employees are eligible for leave-of-absence (LOA) days as per the table below:

PTO Plan	Paid vacation compensation is:
Employees who work 20–29 hours per week	25 hours per year, 2.08 hours accrued monthly

Other Paid Time Off Offered by MIU

Sick Time LOA

Employees are offered 12 non-cumulative sick days per year of employment accrued monthly based on the amount of hours they work per week.

Panchakarma (PK) LOA

After their initial two months of employment, MIU full-time employees can take up to 30 hours of paid time off (non-cumulative) per year to have Panchakarma treatments in the Preventive Health Center. Please see further details about Panchakarma in *Maharishi Vedic Approach to HealthSM* on page 22.

“WPA/Rounding” LOA

After their initial two months of employment, MIU full-time employees practicing the Transcendental Meditation technique can take up to 40 hours of paid time off (non-cumulative) per year to participate in a residence course using their WPA/Rounding LOA hours. Interns are entitled to 20 paid hours, non-cumulative, WPA/Rounding per year. Please see further details about WPA/Rounding in *Meditation Programs and Advanced Courses* on page 19.

Unpaid Leave of Absence

Unpaid LOA can only be taken in emergency situations if paid LOA is not available, if it's been approved by the employee's manager and/or department head, who will be responsible to notify HR.

Please Note: All the benefits set out in this handbook are merely general descriptions. The benefits that you receive may vary from those described. They may be added to, modified, or withdrawn, at any time, at the discretion of the University Council, Personnel Committee, or

Human Resources Department. All benefits are granted according to track and tenure and are subject to change without notice.

STANDARDS OF CONDUCT

Dress Code

MIU adopts a business casual dress code, and we observe dress down Fridays where employees are allowed a more casual and less business attire.

Since we know that the business casual concepts can be quite ambiguous, here are some tips: clothing that works well for the beach, yard work, dance clubs, exercise sessions, and TM program are not appropriate. The same applies to ripped clothes or clothing that reveals too much (back, chest, stomach, or underwear). These will not be appropriate for a place of business, even in a business casual setting.

Last but not least, clothing that has words, terms, or pictures that may be offensive to other employees is unacceptable.

It's important to remember that even during dress down Fridays where employees are allowed to dress more casually, what it's mentioned above as inappropriate will still apply.

Tobacco Policy

According to MIU policy and Iowa state law, no one is permitted to smoke or use tobacco products including the use of nicotine products anywhere at any time on campus. This includes outdoors (roadsides, lawns, sidewalks, etc.), and inside buildings, motor vehicles, and other enclosures. The University's policy is to support the health of our students, faculty, staff, employees, and visitors. Following are procedures, penalties, and fees pertaining to employees found smoking on campus:

First Offense: If an employee is determined by MIU Safety and Security to have been smoking tobacco or using any type of tobacco products on campus, a \$50 fine will be levied. If smoking occurs inside a campus building or MIU vehicle, an additional \$250 Restoration Fee will be added to the fine, bringing the total to \$300. The Restoration Fee is for cleaning, replacing carpet or mattress, repainting or whatever expenses are incurred by the University to make the environment suitable for non-smokers.

\$ 50.00 Smoking Fine
+ \$ 250.00 Room Restoration Fee
\$ 300.00 Total

The fine, or fine plus Restoration Fee, must be paid within 60 days of the date on which the fine is levied, or the employee will be subject to termination.

Second Offense: If MIU Safety and Security determines an employee has been smoking tobacco on campus a second time either indoors or outdoors, a \$100 fine will be levied, and the following provisions will apply:

If the second offense was inside a campus building or MIU vehicle, the \$250 Restoration Fee will apply. The employee must pay the fine and fee, if applicable, or be subject to termination.

Written Documentation of the offense, signed by the employee, is placed in the employee's permanent file.

Third or Subsequent Offense: If MIU Safety and Security determines an employee has been smoking tobacco on campus a third or subsequent time, either indoors or outdoors, a \$100 fine will be levied and paid, or the employee will be suspended. In addition, if this offense was inside a

campus building or MIU vehicle the \$250 Restoration Fee will apply. The employee must pay the fine, and fee if applicable, or be subject to termination. The employee is given notice that any future smoking offence will be grounds for immediate dismissal. A copy of the reprimand is placed in the employee's permanent file.

Disciplinary Meeting: Before an employee is suspended pursuant to this policy, the employee meets with the department head and the Director of the Human Resources Office in accord with the Disciplinary Procedures listed in the Employee Handbook.

Any employee seeking help with smoking cessation is encouraged to speak with the Campus Nurse or any member of the Human Resources Department team.

Drug and Alcohol Prevention Policy (Summary)

MIU prohibits the possession, use, manufacture and/or distribution of alcohol and controlled substances (illicit drugs) on campus and at off-campus courses, trips and events sponsored by MIU.

Maharishi International University promotes and actively facilitates healthy lifestyles free from alcohol and illicit drug use. MIU incorporates into the curriculum and lifestyles of students, faculty, and staff the Transcendental Meditation and the TM-Siddhi program, which have been verified to have benefits in prevention and treatment of alcohol and drug abuse.

For those voluntarily seeking help with their alcohol and illicit drug problems, the University provides confidential and free support services, counseling, and opportunities to take part in support groups. The University also distributes information about support services available off-campus.

MIU investigates all drug and alcohol policy violations and judges them on a case-by-case basis.

Violators of MIU's drug and alcohol policy will be subject to disciplinary action, which might include:

- obligation to attend alcohol or substance abuse treatment,
- obligation to attend alcohol or substance abuse education program,
- temporary or permanent suspension, or
- termination of employment.
- If appropriate, the violation may also be referred to law enforcement.

Following suspension or termination, violators of MIU's drug and alcohol policy can apply for re-admission or re-employment. The University will decide about such requests on a case-by-case basis. The full text of this policy is accessible at <https://services.MIU.edu/campus-security/drug-and-alcohol-prevention-policy/>.

Firearms

To maintain a safe and secure environment for all students, employees, and visitors, Maharishi International University strictly prohibits the possession, use, or storage of firearms on University property. This applies to all employees, students, contractors, vendors, and visitors, regardless of whether they hold a legal permit to carry a firearm.

As a one-strike rule, any violation will result in immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination, as well as potential legal consequences.

Respectful Work Environment

Fraternization Policy

Maharishi International University provides students with a positive and nurturing environment. All employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of professional conduct in their relationships with students. This policy has been adopted to ensure that the legal and human rights of students and employees are always respected, both on and off campus. Any act of harassment, exploitation, or inappropriate fraternization will not be tolerated.

Relationships between individuals in inherently unequal positions may undermine the real or perceived integrity of the teaching, supervision, and evaluation process, as well as affect the trust inherent in the educational and/or work environment. It is the policy of Maharishi International University that persons in unequal positions do not conduct romantic relationships. The University considers it inappropriate for any member of the faculty, administration, or staff to date or establish an intimate relationship with students; or with a subordinate or colleague upon whose academic or work performance they will be required to make professional judgments on.

Teaching and research fellows, doctoral and graduate assistants, tutors, interns, and any other students who perform work-related functions for the University are also subject to this policy.

Anyone who violates this policy is subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. Formal disciplinary action may range from a reprimand to termination of employment or assignment, depending on the gravity of the situation. Employees may be placed on administrative leave (with or without compensation), suspended, or transferred while a case is being reviewed. Decisions regarding administrative leave, suspension, transfer, or dismissal will take into consideration the nature of the appointment, the severity of the offense, any pattern or history of similar incidents, the possible duration of the investigation, and other factors.

This policy is not intended to discourage appropriate and professional interaction between employees and with students. Its purpose is to ensure the safety and wellbeing of all students and employees of Maharishi International University.

The guidelines and definitions in this policy may not be all inclusive. The University will, at all times, take whatever action is necessary to fulfill the intent of the policy and to comply with applicable laws and regulations.

If anyone feels that an exception should be made to this policy, he or she should submit a petition to the Human Resources Department. The petition may be evaluated in consultation with the Dean of Student Life.

Offensive Language

Offensive language is not permitted anywhere on the University premises and is considered grounds for dismissal.

Courteous Behavior

University employees are expected to maintain high standards of harmonious behavior with their co-workers and all those with whom they meet during the day. An infraction of this standard of behavior could be grounds for dismissal.

Title IX and Harassment

Maharishi International University is committed to preventing sexual harassment and violence on campus. Responsible Employees are trained each year in how to be an Active Bystander; using tools and resources to safely intervene in a problematic situation. It is the University's position that harassment of any kind, abuse and offences are unacceptable in any form.

Title IX Concepts

Title IX is a federal law that prohibits excluding an individual from participating in educational programs and activities based on that person's sex. Sexual harassment is a form of such discrimination.

Maharishi International University is a place where we encourage conversation and dialogue about sexual assault prevention, education, and compassionate support. Breaking the culture of silence requires a willingness to engage the community and speak openly about these issues.

The University prohibits all forms of sexual harassment and misconduct on our campus. In this link, you can read more about our [sexual harassment and sexual assault policies](#), which contain specific definitions, but in general, prohibits all conduct of a sexual nature that occurs without consent, including intimate partner violence, stalking, and sexual assault. MIU will act promptly to stop the harassment, prevent its recurrence, and address its effects.

Consent consists of an affirmative, conscious decision by each participant to engage in mutually agreed-upon sexual activity. The person must act freely, voluntarily and have knowledge of the act and who is involved. Consent must be present at every stage and can be withdrawn at any time. An individual who is incapacitated by alcohol or other drugs (including prescriptions) cannot give consent.

The University prohibits retaliation against any individual or group who makes a report, who is named in a report, or who participates in an investigation.

The University will support any individual who is affected by sexual harassment or misconduct, regardless of whether or not disciplinary action is sought. If staff, students, or faculty members believe that they are the victims of such behavior, they should contact their supervisor or department head, faculty tutor, Human Resources Office, Title IX Coordinator, or the Crisis Center at 1-800-464-8340. The University also provides campus resources that are confidential. These include the Student Support Services and the Wellness Clinic Staff.

Educational programs on sex offenses, rape, and acquaintance rape can be obtained through The Crisis Center at 1-800-464-8340, P.O. Box 446, Ottumwa, Iowa 52501.

Sexual assault, rape and other events of that nature may be reported to the Jefferson County Police Department at 1200 West Grimes Street and/or Campus Safety. The Human Resources Office will assist you in notifying these authorities if you wish. For counseling services for victims of such offenses contact may be made with the Mental Health Center of Jefferson County at 2200 West Jefferson Avenue in Fairfield, (641) 472-5771.

Those alleged to have committed such offenses will be subject to an investigation and disciplinary proceedings through the Human Resources Department, which could result in dismissal from the University. Accused and accuser will be notified in writing about any Title IX related investigations and are entitled to have a support person present during any proceedings, and both shall be informed of the outcome of any such proceedings.

Counseling: any employee desiring counseling for drug, alcohol, or sexual abuse should contact the Human Resources Department. You may also look in the phone book under alcohol and drug treatment or counseling programs.

Responsible Employee

According to Title IX, a "responsible employee" is an employee:

- Who has the authority to take action to address events of sexual harassment/violence, or
- Who has been given the duty of reporting incidents of sexual harassment/violence or any other misconduct by students/employees to the Title IX Coordinator or other appropriate school designated official, or

- That a student/employee could reasonably believe has either the authority or the duty listed above.

For Title IX compliance, all MIU employees who are designated as managers or time supervisors, except for the Director of Student Support Services and the Licensed Professional Counselors, are considered “**responsible employees.**” This includes some select student employees as well, such as Resident Hall Director (RDs).

In addition, all Campus Safety Officers and staff, Student Life and Student Affairs staff, Human Resources staff, Exercise and Sport Science (including the Recreation Center) staff, Academic Advisors, Faculty, Instructors, Teaching Assistants, Graduate students that are supervising other students, and any individuals designated as Campus Security Authorities are responsible employees.

A responsible employee must report allegations of sexual harassment/violence that takes place on or off campus to the Title IX Coordinator. The purpose is to maximize MIU’s ability to investigate and potentially address and eliminate sexual harassment/violence. It is important to mention that the responsible employee is not supposed to assess or determine if the harassment/violence did occur, or if a hostile environment is being created, their sole responsibility is to report the events. The Title IX Coordinator together with the Title IX Committee will take the necessary steps to address the issues reported.

The information that responsible employees should report to the Title IX Coordinator includes:

- The name(s) of the alleged perpetrator,
- The student/employee who experienced the alleged harassment and/or violence, and any other student/employee involved,
- The date, time, and location of the alleged incident.

Responsible employees should keep in mind that they CANNOT promise confidentiality, therefore, responsible employees should make students/employees aware of that before they reveal something that they may want to keep confidential. Explain that you want to be supportive, but if they do not want the incident(s) to be reported then they should make an appointment with a confidential resource, such as the Director of Student Support Services, the Wellness Clinic, or the Licensed Professional Counselor. It is also important to mention that in emergency situations, where a person’s health or safety is in immediate danger, you should call 911 and then inform Campus Safety by calling 641-472-1115 or if you’re calling from a Campus extension, dial 1115.

It is considered official notice to the institution if a responsible employee “knew, or in the exercise of reasonable care should have known” about the harassment. This includes incidents that are reported directly, are witnessed, or are reported by a third party (parent, other student), posted on fliers around campus, published in a local newspaper, etc. - **all these MUST be reported to the Title IX Coordinator.**

Definition of Sexual Abuse

Iowa law defines sexual abuse as follows:

Any sex act between persons is sexual abuse by either of the participants when the act is performed with the other participant in any of the following circumstances:

1. The act is done by force or against the will of the other. If the consent or acquiescence of the other is procured by threats of violence toward any person or if the act is done while the other is under the influence of a drug inducing sleep or is otherwise in a state of unconsciousness, the act is done against the will of the other.
2. Such other participant is suffering from a mental defect or incapacity, which precludes giving consent, or lacks the mental capacity to know the right and wrong of conduct in sexual matters.

3. Such other participant is a child (under age 18 and not married).

Iowa Code 709.1 (1992)

This crime is punishable by up to life imprisonment.

Disciplinary Policy and Procedure

Purpose & Scope

The purpose of this disciplinary procedure is to ensure the safe and effective operation of the business and to promote fair treatment of individual employees. The following procedure provides a framework to address any lapses in conduct, performance and/or attendance and encourages individual employees to achieve and maintain an acceptable standard.

This procedure applies to all employees. It does not form part of your terms and conditions of employment.

This policy does not apply to dismissals, where the employment is terminated for a reason unconnected to disciplinary action, such as in the event of redundancy, retirement, budget cuts, or non-renewal of a fixed term contract. If these situations arise MIU will follow a fair and reasonable procedure, which will include proper communication with individual employees prior to any dismissal taking effect.

Informal Warnings

Minor breaches of MIU standards may result in an informal warning being given to employees by their immediate supervisor. The objective of the warning is to help them improve their conduct, performance and/or attendance without having to use a formal procedure.

An informal warning is normally given verbally, although a note should be kept in employees' personnel file of what was discussed and what was agreed. Managers will monitor employees' conduct, performance and/or or attendance over an agreed period. If the managers do not perceive a satisfactory improvement, or there are any further breaches of MIU standards, then the formal disciplinary procedure will be invoked.

Investigation

If it becomes necessary to formally address issues regarding employees' conduct, performance and/or attendance, the matter will first be investigated by either an appropriate manager in the employee's department (usually their supervisor's direct report) or HR if an appropriate manager is not available.

This investigation will be conducted thoroughly and as quickly as possible in all circumstances. Confidentiality will be maintained, as far as is reasonably practicable, during the investigation and throughout the disciplinary process, should this be activated.

Under certain circumstances, including but not limited to harassment, bullying, theft, and violence, MIU may decide to suspend employees on full pay, while the matter is being investigated. This is not a disciplinary sanction, but a way of ensuring that a full review of the circumstances can take place as effectively as possible.

Criminal Charges

Where employees' conduct is the subject of a criminal investigation, charge, or conviction, we will investigate the facts before deciding whether to take formal disciplinary action. We will not usually wait for the outcome of any prosecution before deciding what action, if any, to take.

Where you are unable or have been advised not to attend a disciplinary hearing or say anything about a pending criminal matter, we may have to take a decision based on the available evidence.

A criminal investigation, charge or conviction relating to conduct outside work may be treated as a disciplinary matter if we consider that it is relevant to your employment with MIU.

Disciplinary Meeting

If, after an initial investigation has been conducted, it is considered that there is a case to be answered, employees will be notified of the complaint against them. Employees will be provided with details of any supporting evidence which may be available and will be invited to attend a disciplinary meeting. Employees should take reasonable steps to attend this meeting. If they are unable or unwilling to attend, MIU reserves the right to proceed in their absence.

This meeting will be conducted by either an appropriate manager or HR in case an appropriate manager is not available. MIU may also have someone present at the meeting to take notes.

At this meeting, the nature of the alleged breach of MIU standards will be made clear to the employee and they will be given the opportunity to state their case and call any relevant witnesses. If any additional issues arise during this meeting, an adjournment may take place to allow further investigation.

During the disciplinary process or appeal, employees will be provided with copies of any notes, and interview information that MIU considers to be relevant as soon as they become available, assuming revealing this information is not a threat to any of the parties or witnesses involved in the investigation.

Right to be Accompanied

Employees may bring a companion to any disciplinary hearing or appeal hearing under this procedure. The companion may be a colleague. The companion is not supposed to take part in the investigation process, they are just a support person to the employee. Employees must tell the HR Department who their chosen companion is at least 24 hours before the meeting.

The companion is allowed reasonable time off from duties without loss of pay but no one is obliged to function as a companion if they do not wish to do so. If their companion is unavailable at the time a meeting is scheduled, the employee will be required to choose someone else.

Disciplinary Action

If, at the conclusion of a disciplinary meeting/investigation, or shortly thereafter, it is decided that there has been a breach of standards, formal disciplinary action will be taken.

If an employee is issued with a warning, they will be informed in writing and will receive a copy of the documentation. A copy of the written warning will be kept in their personnel file. If their conduct, performance and/or attendance has reached an acceptable level after the specified period, the warning will be disregarded for disciplinary purposes, but will be kept on their personnel file for historical purposes.

If employees wish to appeal against any level of disciplinary sanction, including dismissal, they should follow the procedure for appeals set out in the "Procedures to appeal against Dismissal or other Disciplinary Action" section.

Stage 1 – Oral Warning

If employees' conduct, performance and/or attendance is unsatisfactory or there is no improvement, or another breach of MIU standards occurs after an informal warning has been issued, employees will be given a formal ORAL WARNING, a note of which will be held on their personnel file. Employees will also be reminded that if there is no improvement, or a further breach occurs, within a specified period, further disciplinary action will be taken.

Stage 2 – Written Warning

If the breach of MIU standards is more serious, or there is no improvement in employee's conduct, performance and/or attendance or another breach of MIU standards occurs, employees will receive a WRITTEN WARNING. This will include the reason for the warning, give details of how they should improve and remind employees that if there is no improvement, or a further breach occurs, within the specified period, further disciplinary action will be taken.

Stage 3 – Final Written Warning

If the breach of MIU standards is very serious, or there is still no improvement in the employee's conduct, performance/attendance, or another breach of MIU standard occurs, despite a previous warning, a FINAL WRITTEN WARNING will be given. This will include the reason for the warning, giving details of how the employee should improve, and reminding said employee that if there is no improvement, or a further breach occurs, within the specified period, said employee may be DISMISSED.

Stage 4 – Dismissal or other disciplinary action

If there is no satisfactory improvement in the employee's conduct, performance and/or attendance or if a further breach of MIU standards occurs, they may be DISMISSED (or other disciplinary action may be taken i.e., demotion/ transfer/ reduction of pay/ suspension without pay). Employees will be informed in writing of the decision, given details of the reason for the dismissal, or other disciplinary action, their termination date (if relevant), the appropriate period of notice or amount of pay in lieu of notice (when appropriate), and details of their right to appeal.

A decision to dismiss or impose other disciplinary action will normally be taken by a senior manager and dismissal will only be applied if MIU does not consider any alternative to dismissal would be appropriate.

If an employee is dismissed under this policy, their employment will terminate on the date specified in writing. Their employment will NOT be suspended pending the outcome of any appeal procedure. Should an appeal reverse the decision to dismiss the employee, such employee will be reinstated with no break in service and any monies owing to the employee will be paid.

Any of the above stages of disciplinary action may be omitted, depending on the seriousness of the misconduct.

Gross Misconduct

If an employee is found guilty of gross misconduct, MIU is entitled to summarily dismiss said employee. This means that the employee will be dismissed with immediate effect, without notice or pay in lieu of notice. Alternatively, MIU may impose another penalty short of dismissal.

Examples of gross misconduct include, but are not limited to:

- Theft, fraud, or deliberate falsification of records.
- Misuse, abuse or deliberate damage to MIU property, including intellectual property, or that of other employees.
- The supply or possession of alcohol or illegal drugs or being under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs on MIU's premises or during working hours.
- Physical violence, actual or threatened.
- Serious act of insubordination.
- Inappropriate use of internet, intranet, and email facilities.
- Harassment or discrimination on any grounds.

- Accepting or offering a bribe.
- Disclosure of confidential information.
- Serious breach of the health and safety rules.
- Serious or repeated negligent acts in the performance of your duties.
- Persistent or serious failure to follow reasonable instructions.
- Giving false or misleading information to MIU.
- Leaving the workplace without permission or reasonable excuse.
- Serious disregard for rules or instructions given by MIU.
- Unauthorized absence.
- Bringing MIU into disrepute.

Procedures to appeal against Dismissal or another Disciplinary Action

Employees' appeal must be made in writing to the Human Resources Department within three working days of the decision being communicated to them in writing and they should detail their reason(s) for appealing against the disciplinary action.

Employees' appeal will be considered by a senior manager and/or an HR representative who, when practicable, will not have had any previous involvement in their case, within five working days of receiving their appeal. If it is anticipated that the appeal process will take longer than five working days from receipt of their appeal, said employee will be informed of this and of the expected timescale.

Employees will be notified of their right to be accompanied at the appeal meeting by a colleague. If additional issues or new evidence arise during this meeting, an adjournment may take place to allow for these to be investigated.

After considering the appeal, a decision may be taken to uphold the dismissal or other disciplinary action or to overturn the findings of the disciplinary meeting. Employees will be informed of the outcome of the appeal and the reasons for the decision in writing, as soon as possible. **The decision which is reached is final.**

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT AND RECEIPT

The employee handbook describes valuable information about Maharishi International University (MIU), and I understand that I should consult the Human Resources Department regarding any questions not answered in the handbook.

I have entered an employment relationship with MIU voluntarily and acknowledge that there is no specified length of employment. Accordingly, either I or MIU can terminate the relationship at will, with or without cause, at any time, so long as there is not violation of applicable federal or state law.

I understand and agree that, other than the President of MIU, no manager, supervisor, or representative of MIU has no authority to enter into any agreement for employment other than at-will; only the President of MIU has the authority to make any such agreement and then only in writing signed by the President of MIU.

This manual and the policies and procedures contained herein supersede all prior practices, oral or written representations, or statements regarding the terms and conditions of my employment at MIU. By distributing this handbook, MIU expressly revokes all previous policies and procedures which are inconsistent with those contained herein.

I understand that, except for employment at-will status, all policies and practices may be changed at any time by MIU, and MIU reserves the right to change my hours, wages and working conditions at any time. All such changes will be communicated through official notices, and I understand that revised information may supersede, modify, or eliminate existing policies. Only the President MIU or the Human Resources Director can adopt any revisions to the policies in this handbook.

I understand and agree that nothing in the Employee Handbook creates, or is intended to create, a promise or representation of continued employment and that employment at MIU is employment at-will, which may be terminated at the will of either MIU or myself. Furthermore, I acknowledge that this handbook is neither a contract of employment nor a legal document. I understand and agree that employment and compensation may be terminated with or without cause and with or without notice at any time by MIU or myself.

I have received the handbook, and I understand that it is my responsibility to read and comply with the policies contained in this handbook and any revisions made to it.

Employee Full Legal Name (please print):

Signature:

Date: